

Shipping Your Project

Autumn term 2026

Practical advice, not rules. The binding rules are in the Requirements document; nothing here changes them. If the two ever disagree, the Requirements win.

”Shipping” means handing over work that someone else can open, read and run without asking you a single question. Most marks lost on this project are lost here — not in the modelling.

The test that matters

Before you submit, do this on a machine that is not the one you worked on:

1. Download your own submission, as a marker would.
2. Unzip it into an empty folder.
3. Follow your own README exactly as written, changing nothing.
4. See whether the results in your paper appear.

If step 4 fails, you have found what the marker would have found. Almost every problem below is caught by this one test.

What to hand over

<code>lastname_firstname/</code>	
<code>paper.pdf</code>	the research paper
<code>README.md</code>	how to reproduce, in order
<code>code/</code>	the scripts and notebooks
<code>data/</code>	the data, or how to get it
<code>figures/</code>	what the paper shows
<code>recording.mp4</code>	or a link, if the file is large

Use lowercase names with no spaces and no accents. `data final (2).csv` breaks on other people's machines; `prices_2020_2024.csv` does not.

The README

Half a page is plenty. In this order:

- what the project does, in two sentences;
- what to install (`pip install -r requirements.txt` is the whole answer, if you write the requirements file);
- what to run, in the order to run it;
- how long it takes, and what it produces;
- where the data came from.

Write it as instructions to a stranger, because that is who reads it.

Code

- **A script that runs top to bottom beats clever code that needs explaining.** You are graded on evidence that you can apply the methods, not on style.
- **Set the random seed.** If your numbers change every run, nobody can check anything in your paper.
- **No absolute paths.** `/Users/anna/Desktop/thesis/data.csv` exists on exactly one computer in the world. Use `data/prices.csv`.
- **Restart the notebook and run it once, in order, before submitting.** Notebooks that work only if cells are run out of order are the most common reproducibility failure there is.
- **Keep secrets out.** No API keys in the code. If your project needs one, say in the README which key is needed and where to put it.

Data

- Small and shareable: include it.
- Large or licensed: include the download script and say plainly what the licence permits. Requirement 4.6 allows this.
- Say where every data set came from and what you did to clean it. "I dropped 412 rows with missing prices" is a sentence the marker wants to read; silence about it is not.

The paper

- Use the SIAM template from the start. Reformatting at the end always costs more than it saves.
- Every figure needs axis labels, units, and a caption saying what to look at.
- Report what you actually ran. If a method failed, that belongs in the paper — Requirement 6.3 lets an honest negative result score full marks.

The recording

- Fifteen minutes, screen plus voice. A Zoom recording of yourself is fine.
- A structure that fits the time: the question (2 min), the data (2 min), the method (4 min), the results (5 min), what you would do next (2 min).
- Watch the first minute back before submitting. Inaudible sound is the usual failure, and it cannot be fixed after the deadline.
- Say your name at the start.

Declaring your tools

Requirement 5 asks which tools you used and what for. A few honest lines:

ChatGPT: drafted the plotting code in `figures.py`; rewrote three paragraphs of the introduction for clarity. All statistical results are my own work and were checked by hand.

Nobody is penalised for using assistants — the course teaches you to. The penalty is for not declaring them, and for being unable to explain what you handed in.

The week before the deadline

- Run the reproduction test above. Now, not on the last evening.

- Check the page count against Requirement 4.2.
- Check the eight required sections are present and in order.
- Submit a first version early. You can replace it; you cannot create it after the deadline.